

INTERVIEW PREPARATION GUIDE

100

HTML, CSS & Tailwind Interview Questions

In Simple, Easy English & Short Answers

Prepared by **Pushkar Singh**

August 2026

A QUICK-REFERENCE INTERVIEW COMPANION

C O N T E N T S

Table of Contents

01	HTML Basics	3
02	HTML Elements & Forms	5
03	CSS Basics	7
04	CSS Box Model & Layout	9
05	CSS Flexbox & Grid	11
06	CSS Positioning, Responsive & Animations	13
07	Tailwind CSS Basics	15
08	Tailwind Layout & Responsive Design	17
09	Tailwind Customization & Utilities	19
10	Miscellaneous & Best Practices	21

Ten questions per chapter — 100 questions in all

HTML Basics

001 What is HTML?

HTML stands for HyperText Markup Language. It is used to create the structure and content of web pages, using elements called tags, like headings, paragraphs, and links.

002 What does HTML stand for?

HTML stands for HyperText Markup Language. "HyperText" means text with links to other pages, and "Markup Language" means we use tags to define the structure of content.

003 What is an HTML tag?

An HTML tag is a keyword surrounded by angle brackets, like `<p>` or `<div>`, used to define a part of the web page, such as a paragraph, image, or link.

004 What is the difference between an element and a tag in HTML?

A tag is the actual keyword written in angle brackets, like `<p>`. An element is the complete structure, including the opening tag, the content, and the closing tag, like `<p>Hello</p>`.

005 What is the basic structure of an HTML document?

The basic structure includes `<!DOCTYPE html>`, then `<html>` as the root tag, containing a `<head>` (for metadata) and a `<body>` (for the visible content of the page).

006 What is the `<!DOCTYPE html>` declaration used for?

The `<!DOCTYPE html>` declaration tells the browser that the document is written using HTML5, so the browser knows how to correctly read and display the page.

007 What is the difference between block-level and inline elements in HTML?

Block-level elements, like `<div>` and `<p>`, take up the full width available and start on a new line. Inline elements, like `<span>` and `<a>`, stay in the same line.

008 What is the difference between `<div>` and `<span>`?

`<div>` is a block-level element, usually used to group larger sections of content. `<span>` is an inline element, usually used to style a small piece of text within a line.

009

What is a semantic HTML element?

A semantic element clearly describes its meaning to both the browser and developers, like `<header>`, `<article>`, and `<footer>`, instead of using generic tags like `<div>`.

010

What is the difference between an id and a class attribute in HTML?

An id is meant to be unique, used only once per page, to identify a single element. A class can be used on multiple elements, applying the same style to a group.

HTML Elements & Forms

011 What is an anchor tag in HTML?

An anchor tag, written as `<a>`, is used to create a hyperlink to another page, a different part of the same page, or an external website, using the `href` attribute.

012 What is the purpose of the `<img>` tag?

The `<img>` tag is used to display an image on a web page. It needs the `src` attribute to point to the image file, and it's good practice to also add an `alt` attribute.

013 What is the alt attribute used for in an image tag?

The `alt` attribute gives a text description of an image, shown if the image fails to load, and it also helps screen readers describe the image to visually impaired users.

014 What are HTML forms used for?

HTML forms are used to collect input from users, like text, choices, or files, using elements like `<input>`, `<textarea>`, and `<button>`, usually to send data to a server.

015 What is the difference between GET and POST methods in an HTML form?

GET sends form data as part of the URL, making it visible and best for simple, non-sensitive data. POST sends form data in the request body, better for larger or sensitive data.

016 What is the purpose of the `<label>` tag in a form?

The `<label>` tag is used to describe an input field, improving accessibility and usability, especially letting users click the label text to focus on the related input.

017 What is the difference between `<input type="text">` and `<input type="password">`?

`<input type="text">` shows the typed characters normally. `<input type="password">` hides the typed characters with dots or asterisks, used for sensitive information.

018 What is the purpose of the placeholder attribute in a form input?

The placeholder attribute shows a light gray hint text inside an input field before the user types anything, guiding them on what kind of information to enter.

019

What are HTML5 semantic tags like `<header>`, `<nav>`, `<section>`, and `<footer>` used for?

These tags describe the purpose of different parts of a web page clearly, making the page structure more organized, readable, and accessible for screen readers.

020

What is the difference between an ordered list and an unordered list in HTML?

An ordered list (`<ol>`) shows items with numbers in a specific sequence. An unordered list (`<ul>`) shows items with bullet points, without any particular order.

CSS Basics

021 What is CSS?

CSS stands for Cascading Style Sheets. It is used to style and design HTML elements, controlling things like colors, fonts, spacing, and layout of a web page.

022 What are the three ways to add CSS to an HTML page?

We can add CSS using inline styles (directly on an element), internal styles (inside a `<style>` tag in the head), or external styles (in a separate `.css` file).

023 What is a CSS selector?

A CSS selector is a pattern used to select which HTML elements we want to style, like selecting by tag name, class, id, or other attributes.

024 What is the difference between a class selector and an id selector in CSS?

A class selector, written with a dot (`.`), can be applied to many elements. An id selector, written with a hash (`#`), should be used on only one unique element per page.

025 What is the CSS box model?

The CSS box model describes how every element is treated as a box, made up of content, padding (space inside), border, and margin (space outside), from inside to outside.

026 What is the difference between padding and margin in CSS?

Padding is the space between an element's content and its border, inside the box. Margin is the space outside the border, between the element and other nearby elements.

027 What is the difference between margin and border in CSS?

Margin is invisible space around the outside of an element's border, used to create distance from other elements. Border is a visible line drawn around the element.

028 What is CSS specificity?

CSS specificity is a set of rules that decide which style applies when multiple CSS rules target the same element, giving more weight to id selectors than class selectors.

029

What is the difference between relative and absolute units in CSS, like px, %, and em?

px is a fixed, absolute unit that always stays the same size. % and em are relative units that change size based on their parent element, making layouts more flexible.

030

What is the purpose of a CSS reset or normalize.css?

A CSS reset or normalize.css removes or standardizes the different default styles that browsers apply to elements, so a website looks more consistent across browsers.

CSS Box Model & Layout

031 What is the box-sizing property in CSS?

box-sizing controls how an element's total width and height are calculated. content-box (default) doesn't include padding and border in the size; border-box includes them.

032 What is the difference between display: block, inline, and inline-block?

block elements take the full width and start on a new line. inline elements stay in the same line. inline-block behaves like inline but still allows setting width and height.

033 What is the difference between visibility: hidden and display: none?

visibility: hidden hides an element but still keeps its space on the page. display: none completely removes the element from the layout, as if it doesn't exist.

034 What is the position property in CSS used for?

The position property controls how an element is placed on the page, with values like static (default), relative, absolute, fixed, and sticky, each behaving differently.

035 What is the difference between position: relative and position: absolute?

position: relative moves an element relative to its own normal position, while still keeping its space.
position: absolute positions it relative to its nearest positioned ancestor.

036 What is a CSS pseudo-class?

A pseudo-class is used to style an element based on a special state, like :hover (mouse over it), :focus (when selected), or :first-child (the first item in a group).

037 What is a CSS pseudo-element?

A pseudo-element lets us style a specific part of an element, like ::before and ::after, which can add extra content before or after an element without changing the HTML.

038 What is the z-index property used for?

z-index controls the stacking order of overlapping elements, where a higher number means the element appears in front of elements with a lower z-index.

039

What is the overflow property in CSS?

The overflow property controls what happens when content is too big for its container, with values like visible (default), hidden, scroll, or auto, to add scrollbars.

040

What is the difference between em and rem units in CSS?

em is relative to the font size of its parent element, so it can compound in nested elements. rem is relative only to the root (html) element's font size.

CSS Flexbox & Grid

041 What is Flexbox in CSS?

Flexbox is a layout system in CSS used to arrange items in a row or column, making it easy to align, space out, and distribute items inside a container.

042 How do you create a flex container?

We create a flex container by setting `display: flex` on a parent element, which then lets us control the layout of its direct children using flex properties.

043 What is the difference between `justify-content` and `align-items` in Flexbox?

`justify-content` aligns items along the main axis, like horizontally in a row. `align-items` aligns items along the cross axis, like vertically in a row.

044 What does the `flex-direction` property do?

`flex-direction` sets the direction items are placed in a flex container, like row (default, left to right) or column (top to bottom), or their reversed versions.

045 What is the `flex-wrap` property used for?

`flex-wrap` controls whether flex items should stay on a single line (nowrap, default) or move to the next line (wrap) if there isn't enough space in the container.

046 What is CSS Grid?

CSS Grid is a layout system that lets us arrange elements into rows and columns at the same time, good for designing full page layouts with more complex structures.

047 How do you create a grid container?

We create a grid container by setting `display: grid` on a parent element, and then define its structure using properties like `grid-template-columns` and `grid-template-rows`.

048 What is the difference between Flexbox and CSS Grid?

Flexbox is mainly designed for one-dimensional layouts, like a single row or column. CSS Grid is designed for two-dimensional layouts, handling rows and columns together.

049

What does `grid-template-columns` do in CSS Grid?

`grid-template-columns` defines how many columns a grid has and how wide each column should be, like `grid-template-columns: 1fr 1fr 1fr` for three equal columns.

050

What is the `fr` unit in CSS Grid?

The `fr` unit stands for "fraction". It divides the remaining space in a grid container into equal or proportional parts among the columns or rows.

CSS Positioning, Responsive & Animations

051 What is responsive web design?

Responsive web design means creating a website that adjusts and looks good on different screen sizes, like phones, tablets, and desktops, using flexible layouts and media queries.

052 What is a media query in CSS?

A media query lets us apply different CSS styles based on conditions, like screen width, using `@media`, so the layout can change for different devices.

053 What is the mobile-first approach in responsive design?

Mobile-first means designing the basic styles for small screens first, and then adding extra styles using media queries for larger screens, instead of the other way around.

054 What is the viewport meta tag used for?

The viewport meta tag tells the browser how to control the page's dimensions and scaling on mobile devices, usually set with `width=device-width` and `initial-scale=1.0`.

055 What is a CSS transition?

A CSS transition lets a property smoothly change from one value to another over time, like changing a button's color slowly when hovered, instead of changing instantly.

056 What is a CSS animation?

A CSS animation lets us create more complex, multi-step visual effects using `@keyframes`, defining how styles should change at different points in time, without needing JavaScript.

057 What is the difference between a CSS transition and a CSS animation?

A transition works between two states, like normal and hover, triggered by an event. An animation can have multiple steps using keyframes and can run automatically.

058 What is a CSS variable (custom property)?

A CSS variable lets us store a reusable value, like a color or size, using two dashes (`--main-color: blue;`), and use it anywhere with `var(--main-color)`.

059

What is the difference between absolute and relative paths in CSS/HTML?

A relative path points to a file based on the current file's location, like images/logo.png. An absolute path gives the complete address of a file, including the full URL.

060

Why is it important to write clean and organized CSS?

Clean and organized CSS is easier to read, maintain, and update later. It helps avoid duplicate styles and makes it easier for other developers to work with the code.

Tailwind CSS Basics

061 What is Tailwind CSS?

Tailwind CSS is a utility-first CSS framework that lets us style elements by adding small, ready-made class names directly in the HTML, instead of writing custom CSS.

062 What does "utility-first" mean in Tailwind CSS?

Utility-first means Tailwind gives us many small, single-purpose classes, like `text-center` or `p-4`, that we combine directly in HTML to build a design.

063 How is Tailwind CSS different from Bootstrap?

Bootstrap provides ready-made components, like buttons and cards, with their own default look. Tailwind gives low-level utility classes instead, for a more custom design.

064 How do you install Tailwind CSS in a project?

We can install Tailwind CSS using npm, then set up a configuration file and add Tailwind's directives to our main CSS file to start using its classes.

065 What is the `tailwind.config.js` file used for?

`tailwind.config.js` is the main configuration file for Tailwind CSS, letting us customize things like colors, fonts, spacing, and breakpoints for our project's design.

066 What is a utility class in Tailwind CSS?

A utility class is a small, single-purpose class name, like `text-lg` or `bg-blue-500`, that applies one specific style, combined together directly in the HTML.

067 How do you apply padding and margin using Tailwind CSS?

We use classes like `p-4` for padding on all sides, or `px-4` and `py-2` for specific sides, and similarly `m-4`, `mx-4`, or `my-2` for margin.

068 How do you set text color and background color in Tailwind CSS?

We use classes like `text-red-500` to set text color and `bg-blue-500` to set background color, where the number usually controls how light or dark the shade is.

069

What is the purge/content configuration in Tailwind CSS used for?

The content (previously called purge) configuration tells Tailwind which files to scan for class names, so it can remove unused CSS from the final build.

070

What is the difference between Tailwind's default classes and arbitrary values?

Default classes use Tailwind's built-in scale, like `p-4` or `text-lg`. Arbitrary values let us use a custom, one-off value directly, like `w-[23px]`, when needed.

Tailwind Layout & Responsive Design

071 How do you create a flex layout using Tailwind CSS?

We add the flex class to a container to make it a flex container, and then use classes like justify-center, items-center, or flex-col to control layout.

072 How do you create a grid layout using Tailwind CSS?

We add the grid class to a container, then use classes like grid-cols-3 to set the number of columns and gap-4 to add spacing between grid items.

073 How does responsive design work in Tailwind CSS?

Tailwind uses responsive prefixes, like sm:, md:, and lg:, added before a utility class, so that style only applies starting from that screen size, mobile-first.

074 What does the class md:text-center mean in Tailwind CSS?

md:text-center means the text-center style (centering text) is applied only on medium-sized screens and larger, based on Tailwind's default breakpoint for md.

075 How do you center a div horizontally using Tailwind CSS?

We can center a div horizontally using classes like mx-auto along with a fixed width, or by using a flex container with justify-center on the parent.

076 What are Tailwind's default breakpoints?

Tailwind's common default breakpoints are sm (small), md (medium), lg (large), xl (extra large), and 2xl (extra extra large), each a different minimum screen width.

077 How do you hide an element on small screens but show it on larger screens using Tailwind?

We can use a class like hidden md:block, which hides the element by default and shows it as a block element only on medium screens and above.

078 What is the space-x and space-y utility used for in Tailwind CSS?

space-x and space-y add consistent spacing between child elements horizontally or vertically, without adding margin to each individual child element separately.

079

How do you make an image responsive using Tailwind CSS?

We commonly use classes like `w-full` and `h-auto` on an image, so it takes the full width of its container while keeping its height in the correct proportion.

080

How does Tailwind CSS help with consistent spacing across a project?

Tailwind uses a predefined spacing scale, applied consistently across padding, margin, and gaps, so all spacing values throughout a project stay uniform and manageable.

Tailwind Customization & Utilities

081 How do you add custom colors in Tailwind CSS?

We can add custom colors by extending the `theme.colors` section inside the `tailwind.config.js` file, giving our own color names and hex values to use as classes.

082 What is the `@apply` directive used for in Tailwind CSS?

`@apply` lets us combine multiple Tailwind utility classes into one custom CSS class, useful when we want to reuse the same combination of styles without repeating them.

083 How do you create custom spacing values in Tailwind CSS?

We can add custom spacing values by extending the `theme.spacing` section inside `tailwind.config.js`, creating new width, height, padding, or margin options.

084 What are Tailwind CSS variants?

Variants are special prefixes, like `hover:`, `focus:`, and `dark:`, that apply a utility class only under a certain condition or state, like on mouse hover.

085 How do you apply hover styles using Tailwind CSS?

We add the `hover:` prefix before a utility class, like `hover:bg-blue-700`, so that style only takes effect when the user hovers their mouse over that element.

086 How does dark mode work in Tailwind CSS?

Tailwind supports dark mode using the `dark:` prefix on utility classes, and it can switch based on the user's system settings or manually using a class on the HTML tag.

087 What are Tailwind plugins used for?

Plugins let us add extra features or utility classes to Tailwind that aren't included by default, like special typography or form styles, by registering them in the config.

088 What is JIT (Just-In-Time) mode in Tailwind CSS?

JIT mode generates CSS classes on demand as they are used in the project, instead of creating all possible classes upfront, making builds faster and more flexible.

089

How can you group related utility classes for readability in Tailwind?

We can use the `@apply` directive to combine related utilities into a single custom class, or use consistent formatting and a class-sorting tool to keep things organized.

090

Why do some developers prefer Tailwind CSS over writing custom CSS?

Tailwind speeds up development by letting developers style directly in HTML, keeps styles consistent using a predefined design scale, and avoids growing, hard-to-manage CSS files.

Miscellaneous & Best Practices

091 What is the difference between HTML, CSS, and Tailwind CSS?

HTML defines the structure and content of a web page. CSS is the language used to style that content. Tailwind CSS is a framework that provides ready-made classes to write that CSS faster.

092 Why is it recommended to use external CSS files instead of inline styles?

External CSS files keep style separate from content, making the HTML cleaner and easier to read, and let us reuse the same styles across multiple pages.

093 What is cross-browser compatibility in web development?

Cross-browser compatibility means making sure a website looks and works correctly across different web browsers, since they can sometimes render HTML and CSS slightly differently.

094 What is the purpose of comments in HTML and CSS?

Comments, written like `<!-- comment -->` in HTML or `/* comment */` in CSS, are notes for developers that are ignored by the browser, used to explain or disable code.

095 What is accessibility (a11y) in web development?

Accessibility means designing websites so people with disabilities can also use them easily, using things like proper alt text, labels, and keyboard-friendly navigation.

096 What is the difference between a framework and a library in the context of CSS?

A library gives us optional tools we can pick and use. A framework, like Tailwind or Bootstrap, provides a more complete structure that shapes how we build the whole design.

097 Why is it a good practice to keep HTML, CSS, and JavaScript separate?

Keeping them separate makes code easier to read, maintain, and reuse, since each file focuses on one job: structure (HTML), style (CSS), and behavior (JavaScript).

098 What are browser developer tools used for in web development?

Browser developer tools let us inspect HTML elements, check and edit CSS styles live, debug JavaScript, and test how a website looks on different screen sizes.

099

What is minification in the context of CSS?

Minification removes unnecessary spaces, line breaks, and comments from a CSS file, making the file size smaller so the website loads faster for users.

100

What are some good practices when writing HTML, CSS, or Tailwind code?

Good practices include using semantic HTML tags, keeping class names organized, writing responsive and accessible designs, avoiding duplicate styles, and testing on multiple devices.